AANGAN · FURNITURE COMMERCE

A room for the decision.

Moving from liking a piece of furniture to knowing where—and how—it belongs.

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Product design and development case study, based on the supplied domain notes and current interactive prototype. Proposed service improvements and validation plans are distinguished from the visible implementation.

Explore the prototype

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A room for the decision

Furniture shopping starts with a photograph. The difficult part comes afterwards: imagining the chair in a real room, judging whether its dimensions make sense, and working out what happens when it arrives. I built Aangan around that gap between liking a piece and feeling ready to buy it.

My role spans product design and development. The current app is an interactive furniture shopping prototype. This study brings together my supplied domain notes and the experience visible in that prototype. It does not report a completed customer research programme or a measured change in sales.

01 / The problem behind the product grid

A chair can look right on a screen and still be wrong for a home. It might interrupt the walking path, feel different from the fabric in the photograph, or fail to turn through the entrance. A product grid answers “What can I buy?” much more easily than “Can I live with this?”

The notes I started with covered the whole journey: discovery, evaluation, room previews, checkout, delivery, assembly and support. I used them as questions to investigate, rather than treating every observation as an established finding. The recurring design problem was uncertainty. Adding more products would not resolve it.

That gave me a narrower brief: help someone move from a piece they like to a decision they can explain. What is it made of? How much space does it take? What does the price include? What still needs checking before payment?

02 / Two kinds of fit

The first kind is easy to picture: does this belong in my room? Colour, shape and proportion all matter. The second is less visible: can it get into the room, and will it work there day after day?

I separated room fit from delivery access because a positive answer to one does not answer the other. A chair can sit comfortably beside a sofa and still be awkward to carry through a narrow door. A room preview should not silently become a delivery guarantee.

This distinction also changes when information appears. Dimensions belong beside the product, not behind a long specification sheet. Questions about doors and assembly belong before the buyer commits, not in a support conversation after purchase.

03 / A smaller collection, with more useful detail

The current collection introduces the Sunday Armchair, Cloud Linen Chair, Pearl Table Lamp and Arc Walnut Table alongside a wider range of furniture. Categories now include sofas, chairs, tables, beds, storage, outdoor furniture and lighting. A room-check prompt appears before the featured products. I wanted browsing to lead naturally into the question of whether a piece belongs in the buyer's space.

Product cards show a width alongside the name and price. On the Sunday Armchair page, the buyer can see the finish, width, depth and height together: burnt orange, 78 cm wide, 82 cm deep and 82 cm high. Those details make comparison possible without asking someone to remember measurements from another screen.

The material description is short: textured weave and walnut legs. That is a starting point, not a complete quality assessment. A production catalogue would need verified construction details, care guidance, material photography and supplier-backed specifications. Attractive wording cannot substitute for evidence about the product.

04 / Let the room do some of the explaining

“Try in your room” is available from the collection. The current app also offers a room-and-doorway check, introduced as four steps: measure, check access, explore in 3D and find your fit. On the product page, the interactive 3D area labels the object as an original concept model, says its dimensions match the catalogue and asks the buyer to confirm finishes with the seller.

That label matters. I want people to understand what they are looking at. A concept model is useful for exploring shape and scale; it does not prove fabric texture, comfort, colour accuracy or delivery clearance. Matching catalogue dimensions is a claim made by the app, not an independent physical measurement.

The dimension route is equally important. Someone who cannot use a camera preview, or simply prefers measuring, should still be able to make progress. The next iteration should make the difference between measured dimensions, estimated placement and unchecked access unmistakable.

For a fit check, I would show the inputs and the remaining uncertainty instead of a confident green tick. “The chair is 78 cm wide; you entered an 85 cm opening” is a more useful explanation than “It fits.” Packaging, turning space and the delivery method may still change that answer.

05 / Bring the awkward questions forward

The Sunday Armchair page includes “Will it fit through my door?” and “Delivery, assembly & returns.” Its displayed price of ₹14,990 is accompanied by “Includes taxes, delivery & assembly.” These are visible parts of the current prototype, not evidence that a fulfilment service is operating.

My design intention is to bring purchase conditions close to the decision. If a charge depends on the buyer's location, floor or installation needs, the production flow must calculate it before payment and explain the change. A promise on the product page needs to agree with the final total.

I would carry that principle into a delivery-readiness step: confirm the address, access constraints, building delivery hours and whether assembly is required. The step should ask only what changes the order, explain why it matters, and allow the buyer to correct it.

Not every customer will know a lift dimension immediately. Saving an incomplete check is better than encouraging a guess. The next action could be as ordinary as "Measure the lift opening before confirming delivery."

06 / A purchase can take more than one sitting

Furniture decisions often involve more than one person. My notes raised questions about shared preferences, family budgets, comfort and maintenance. These are useful scenarios for design, but I have not presented them as interview findings.

Aangan's current navigation includes Discover, Explore, Room check, Saved and Bag. That structure supports an experience people can return to, rather than assuming every visit ends in a purchase.

A shared shortlist is a sensible next step. I would start with a link to a few saved products and their dimensions, not a complicated household collaboration system. Before adding comments or voting, I would test whether people can already make a decision with a simple, consistent comparison.

07 / Where the interface ends and the service begins

The app can surface a delivery promise. Keeping that promise requires someone to own the handover between the warehouse, delivery team, assembler and support team.

For a production service, I would define one order timeline that distinguishes delivery from installation and names the next responsible party. A damaged component should be reported against the affected item, with photographs attached once, rather than making the customer restart the story with each team.

These are proposed service flows. The current prototype does not establish real-time courier tracking, a coordinated installation network or a functioning parts-replacement operation. Showing those ideas as delivered outcomes would hide the hardest work still to do.

08 / What I would test first

The first task would be deliberately practical: choose an armchair for a measured space and explain why it will work. I would observe whether someone notices the width, understands the preview's limits and checks the entrance as well as the room.

A second task would ask the buyer to explain the final cost and what happens after payment. If they cannot tell whether assembly is included or where to find a damage policy, the flow has not earned their confidence.

I would test on a modest phone as well as a desktop. The fallback from a room preview matters as much as the preview itself. A failed camera session should lead back to dimensions and product information without losing the selected piece.

The measures would begin with task completion, incorrect fit assumptions and questions left unanswered. After a real launch, I would connect those observations to fit-related returns, failed first delivery attempts, assembly support requests and satisfaction after installation. Conversion alone would be an incomplete result if returns increased with it.

09 / Monetisation: earn on the furniture, not the uncertainty

The revenue model I would start with is straightforward retail: sell furniture and lighting, and retain the amount left after sourcing and fulfilling the order. The catalogue, prices, product details and bag support that direction. They do not establish live sales, supplier contracts or a working payment settlement system.

For this model, Aangan would need a seller or retail operator that can own the catalogue and delivery promise. I have not treated it as a multi-vendor marketplace or assumed it earns a commission from independent sellers; neither is established by the screens reviewed here.

The displayed Sunday Armchair price is ₹14,990, with taxes, delivery and assembly described as included. That is a customer-facing price, not the business's profit. I would calculate contribution per fulfilled order as sales revenue excluding taxes, less the product cost, delivery, assembly, payment charges and an allowance for damage, returns and support. Acquisition cost would then show whether the remaining contribution can support growth.

The practical implication is that a larger basket is not automatically a better order. Adding a lamp to a chair might increase revenue, but extra handling or a second shipment could consume the margin. Related-product suggestions should be tested against contribution and successful fulfilment, not basket value alone.

I would keep the room check available before purchase. Its job is to support the furniture sale. Charging for a basic fit answer would add friction at the point where the buyer is trying to reduce

uncertainty. Paid design consultations could be considered later, but they are not a current service or an assumed revenue stream in this study.

10 / How this could help the business

There are three plausible routes to value. Visible dimensions and access checks could prevent some unsuitable orders. Clear materials and purchase conditions could reduce repetitive questions. Saved products and a coherent collection could help a buyer resume a decision instead of starting again.

Each route needs evidence. I would track fit-related cancellations and returns separately from damage, comfort and finish complaints; a doorway check cannot solve all of them. For support, I would compare the number and handling time of sizing or delivery questions per order. For purchasing, I would look at completed, fulfilled orders rather than treating an add-to-bag event as revenue.

People who use a room check may already be more serious buyers. A higher conversion rate in that group would not, by itself, prove the checker caused the difference. A controlled rollout, with the same products and comparable traffic, would give a more useful test.

The business case succeeds only if the value of additional fulfilled orders and avoided problems exceeds the cost of product data, 3D assets, support and fulfilment. No conversion uplift, return reduction or profit figure has been measured for Aangan in this study.

11 / What the work changed

Aangan gave me a clearer way to think about furniture commerce. The product page is also the beginning of a service agreement: what is being bought, what is included and what the buyer still needs to check.

The prototype now puts dimensions, room exploration and purchase conditions in the shopping path. The next work is to validate those interactions with buyers, replace illustrative product information with verified catalogue data, and connect the experience to a service that can keep its promises.

I would consider the design successful when someone can say why a piece belongs in their home—and knows what will happen next.

End of field note / Sahil Sahu